

MILWAUKIE & NORTHERN CLACKAMAS

Walter B. York Is Drowned In River

MILWAUKIE, Dec. 4.—Walter B. York of Milwaukie, mailcarrier to the houseboat colonies and other residents along the Willamette river between Oak Grove and the Portland Motorboat club, was drowned at 9:30 o'clock Tuesday morning just above the Sellwood ferry when the motorboat in which he operated out of Milwaukie capsized as the result of striking a Nickum & Kelly sand barge.

Efforts of workmen on the barge to save York's life were unavailing, and he sank after a brief struggle, when a rowboat with a rescue party was within two feet of him.

Officers Ahern and Voderberg of the harbor patrol and City Grappler Brady went to the scene of the tragedy and made a vain effort to locate the body. The current was so swift, however, at that point that the grappling irons would not touch bottom, and the men had to give up the search. The launch was located further down the river, where it had been swept by the current. The man's hat was also discovered by one of the workmen on the barge. One of the mail sacks was also recovered.

The body has not been found yet. He is survived by his wife, Mrs. York, who nearly always accompanied her husband on the trips, but owing to the cold weather did not go yesterday. Mrs. York is suffering from the shock and is being cared for by her parents, Mr. and Mrs. L. L. Gray.

Mr. York was a favorite with every one along the route. His cheerful disposition and cheery word and smile will be missed.

Birkemiers Are Struck By Auto

Mr. and Mrs. Dan Birkemier was struck and knocked down by an auto belonging to the Honeyman Hardware Co., of Portland, Sunday on the river road just this side of Island station. Both were painfully hurt but not seriously. They are being cared for at the home of Mr. F. Birkemier.

MRS. TOWNLEY RECOVERING.

MILWAUKIE, Dec. 4.—Mrs. Dr. Townley who was seriously injured about two months ago when she was struck by an auto driven by Mr. Carlson of Island station, on Main street, is at home now and is able to walk with the aid of a cane.

SMALLPOX AT MILWAUKIE.

MILWAUKIE, Dec. 4.—There were several new cases of smallpox developed this week and are being looked after by a nurse from Oregon City. All the cases are of a mild form. No spread of the disease is expected.

WALKER UNDERGOES OPERATION

Virgil Walker underwent an operation for the removal of his tonsils on Tuesday. He will remain in Portland until he recovers.

HIGH SCHOOL NEWS.

The Junior Class is striving to produce an all high school paper. If the publication materializes it will probably appear once a month.

PROFESSIONAL CARDS

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Sellwood Oregon

U. S. Fuel Administration Figures Show Mine Workers Average \$1,600 Per Year

In 1918, Men Working in Bituminous Fields Were Paid More Than \$850,000,000, or 70 Per Cent of Entire Cost of Production.

Figures compiled from official government records and presented at the first conference of bituminous miners and operators at Washington show that the average annual wage paid to the mine workers throughout the United States is approximately \$1,600—or about \$400 more than the average "salary" of ministers and college professors.

The data furnished by the Fuel Administrator showed that in 1918 the total production of bituminous coal was 579,335,820 tons. Of the cost of production, about 30 per cent went for supplies and general expense, while substantially 70 per cent, or slightly more than \$1.50 per ton was paid to labor. In other words, the total wages paid the mine workers in 1918 amounted to about \$870,000,000.

As there are approximately 550,000 mine workers employed in the bituminous fields of this country, the average annual wage paid them was about \$1,600. Many thousands of the miners received a great deal more than this, however, as the average wage figure is based on all grades of workers, including the boys from 16 to 18 years of age who earned about \$2.50 per day as slate pickers, couriers, greasers and trappers. Their comparatively low earnings naturally reduce the average for the entire field.

In the bituminous industry the mine employees are divided into two classes. The pick miners, machine cutters and loaders, all termed miners, are paid by the ton. The more coal they mine or load, the greater their income. Many of these men earn between \$3,000 and \$4,000 a year. The other employees—motor runners, drivers, tick layers, cagers, tipples men, etc.—are, from the nature of their work, paid by the day. The more days they work, the greater their income. The normal work day is eight hours.

Statistics from the Kanawha field, which is typical of the great majority of the fields, throw considerable light on the whole subject of mine wages. Recently, the payrolls of 25 mines in that district were examined to determine the actual earnings of the mine workers. These figures, which covered a period of six months, showed that the highest paid employees—the cutters, loaders and pick miners—earned anywhere from \$6.12 per day up to \$15.12 per day, averaging \$9.13 per day. The other class of mine em-

ployees, the so-called day men, earned from \$4.25 to \$7 per day. The boys working as couriers, greasers and trappers earned from \$2.30 to \$2.55 per day.

It is interesting to note that the miners work only 5 days out of every 6 days the mines are running and work is offered. They remain idle on the other day of their own choice.

In submitting his figures to the operators and mine workers at the Washington conference, Dr. Garfield said he wished to call attention to the importance of recognizing the danger that exists in using averages in connection with a problem in which there is so wide a difference in costs, realizations and margins as exists in the bituminous coal industry. He said, therefore, that any average employed should be taken as a base and not as a figure applicable to any special mine or field.

The Fuel Administrator made plain to both the operators and min-

ers that he was appearing before them in the interest of the consuming public, and that the public, as the chief party in interest in the present crisis, was not in a mood to tolerate either excessive prices or prolonged stoppage of production.

Concerning the operators' profits Dr. Garfield said that the margin of 46 cents per ton left them in 1918 included profit but did not represent profit only, inasmuch as interest charges, selling expense, Federal taxes and certain other items not allowed in computing costs of production, were paid out of it. Consequently the charges made from time to time that they were making excessive profits were not actually justified by the facts. This year, he said, with production costs averaging about 13 cents per ton higher than last year, the profits of the operators would be still further reduced. Many of the operators are now making losses from other businesses worst than the financial hazards of coal.

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OAK GROVE

If you have any items of news for the Oregon City Enterprise please hand same to Mrs. V. G. Benzie. They will be appreciated. Your subscription will receive prompt attention.

North Dakota Man Will Winter Here

OAK GROVE, Dec. 4.—Mr. and Mrs. W. Wugels, of Minnesota, arrived last week to spend the winter with their son, W. F. Wugels.

J. Colasky of North Dakota reached here last week to spend the winter as has been his custom for several years past. Mr. Colasky says this is the best climate for the winter and reports the most severe weather in North Dakota that has been for many years at this time of year.

C. D. Goss of Silverton, is visiting with H. Spaulding for a few weeks. Mrs. E. C. Blanchard was calling on friends here Tuesday.

F. A. Smith transacted business in Portland Tuesday.

R. Straus and wife spent Thanksgiving with Mrs. Straus' mother, Mrs. J. Jones near Clackamas.

Mrs. G. Davenport and Mrs. V. Benzie were Portland visitors Thursday.

Mrs. M. Wetzel, of Hillsboro, spent Thanksgiving with her mother, Mrs. J. Higham.

Miss Hester Armstrong has returned from Eatonsville and accepted a position in Ladd & Tilton's bank, Portland.

F. A. Smith and wife were dinner guests of friends in Portland Thanksgiving.

Master Robt. Wetzel went to Hillsboro Friday to spend a few days with his parents there.

Mr. and Mrs. L. H. Hastings returned from Reedsport recently and will spend part of the winter if not all of it with parents of Mrs. Hastings, Mr. and Mrs. O. T. Skoog.

Dorothy and Lucille Robinson of Washington, are visiting their uncle W. E. Thomas and family.

Mr. and Mrs. J. H. Woodcock are the happy parents of a baby girl born Saturday, November 29.

W. H. Miller of Dayton, spent four or five days here last week on business.

J. Baugie and family left for San Diego Sunday to make their home.

L. A. Cummings, wife and daughter, left on Rose City for Los Angeles, where they will spend the winter.

The pupils in 3d, 4th, 5th and 6th grades gave Thanksgiving entertainments Wednesday of last week, when they presented the Pilgrim Fathers. It was well put on and much enjoyed by those present and much credit is due to the teachers, Miss H. Gaudin and Miss J. Lagerstrom as well as to the pupils.

Mrs. Gillespie was a Portland visitor Friday.

Mrs. J. E. Green is much improved from her illness with pneumonia.

The Social Service Club of Oak Grove will meet with Mrs. W. O. Pierce Friday and after the regular business a fine program was enjoyed.

Musical selections, Mrs. G. S. Davenport; "Thanksgiving" (History and Purpose) Mrs. A. Christianson talk one country, one language, one flag, by Mrs. W. Sellwood and domestic relations and the child (Paper) Mrs. J. J. Goss. Three new members admitted. The next meeting will be held Thursday, December 11.

The road meeting of district No. 1

held last Friday at Harmony resulted in a committee of nine being appointed to confer with the county judge regarding the re-establishing of the old boundaries in districts 47, 38 and 1—now comprising district No. 1.

The Child Welfare department of Social Service club met with Miss E. K. Matthews Thursday evening at which time discussion on Americanization of the foreign born child led by Mrs. C. Hale and Miss Matthews was of much interest.

Mrs. Phil Outfield and Miss K. Thelsson were Portland visitors last Saturday.

Sam Roley, son of Mrs. H. Calearo, has returned from service.

Election for establishing water district will be held Saturday, December 6. The district will be composed of school districts of Concord, Oak Grove and district of Milwaukie south of present water district. Five commissioners are to be elected who will obtain an estimate of laying mains, etc., and unless it is found the assessed valuation in the incorporated districts is sufficient to meet this expense it is understood the matter will rest until there is a reduction in costs of materials.

Mrs. L. Holm and children went to see Santa Claus at the stores in Portland Tuesday.

Mrs. S. Berglund and Mrs. F. A. Smith were in Portland Tuesday in the interest of the Ladies Aid of Community church.

The political department of Social Service club met Tuesday evening. The league of women voters and several amendments to our present laws were taken up and discussed and will be continued at their next meeting before action is taken.

Gilbert W. Allen, of Salem, was among the Oregon City visitors Tuesday and Wednesday.

Mr. and Mrs. Edward Wyland, of Seaside Mills, were visiting in Oregon City Tuesday and Wednesday.

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